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Top Skills

Artificial Intelligence (AI)
Skill Development
Performance Motivation

Languages

English (Native or Bilingual)
German (Limited Working)
French (Limited Working)
Italian (Elementary)

Publications

Pro PHP Application Performance:
Tuning PHP Web Projects for
Maximum Performance
MongoDB in Action
The Definitive Guide to MongoDB:
The NoSQL Database for Cloud and
Desktop Computing
The Definitive Guide to MongoDB -
Third Edition

Tim Hawkins

AI Architect
Bangkok City, Thailand

Summary

Experienced technology leader, with extensive exposure to modern methods of organizing and managing teams for the production of scalable services. I have worked extensively with managing multi-location, multi timezone and multi-culture development teams, being able to knit them together into a functioning whole.

Able to lead by doing and not just by saying, I have always lead technical teams by being as proficient in the subject matter as they are, and demonstrating that the goals i demand are achievable.

My background as a Systems and Solutions Architect, specializing in online and off-line publishing systems, especially database-driven content, has stood me in good stead in this.

Online ECommerce and Retail, Classifieds, specialized in highly scalable solutions for publishing and retail are other day-to-day technologies I harness. I have some experience with the Microsoft EcoSystem, but my main skill sets lie in the Linux and FreeBSD spaces.

I have had significant experience with stabilizing large legacy codebases in both C++ and PHP, and putting automated technical compliance programs in places.

I am a strong believer in "soft infrastructure", with modern tools like Docker, cri-o, and Kubernetes there is no excuse for people manually building out deployments.

I have worked extensively with data extraction , analysis and aggregation tools, I was responsible for building automated content aquisition tooling using tools such as Autonomy and OpenCalais to perform categorisation and tagging of the data sets, more recently I have been looking at LLM models to more cleanly perform the same

tasks. I am particularly interested in running LLM models at the edge with topic focused training.

Lately I have been working on rolling out AI generative development tools and content navigation tools inside the London Stock Exchange Group (LSEG), tools like GitHub Copilot, and Copilot Studio.

Specialties include C, C++, C#, PHP Lamp stacks, Search Engines, Advertising Networks, p2p Publishing networks, Postscript RIPs, news content aggregation and feed processing, wire service management systems, newspaper and classifieds publishing tools, graphics rendering engines. eCommerce Systems, Scalability, Secure coding, Cloud-based Systems (EC2). development build, quality and security systems automation, Payment and fulfillment solutions. Large scale vertical social networks, content acquisition, and aggregation.

Experience

Refinitiv, an LSEG business

AI Architect

June 2023 - Present (3 years 3 months)

Bangkok, Bangkok City, Thailand

LSEG (London Stock Exchange Group)

2 years 5 months

Director of Developer Tools

July 2022 - June 2023 (1 year)

Metro Manila

Technical Leader at LSEG

February 2021 - August 2022 (1 year 7 months)

National Capital Region, Philippines

Refinitiv

Technical Leader

October 2020 - February 2021 (5 months)

National Capital Region, Philippines

The Red Flag Group

CTO

July 2016 - October 2020 (4 years 4 months)

Manila, National Capital Region, Philippines

US Auto Parts

Vice President - Applications Development

2009 - July 2016 (7 years)

National Capital Region, Philippines

Managing and training a team of 75 Engineers, producing a wide range of web based eComm systems, Engaged in Updating and migrating all development activities to scrum agile, putting operational support in place, setting up collaborative development processes between multiple geographically dispersed teams, some in house some out house. devising recruitment and retention programs for top engineering skills.

Contextured Ltd

CIO

November 2008 - October 2009 (1 year)

London, England, United Kingdom

Contextured is a high-tech start-up operating in the advertising space, as Information Technical architect I am responsible for platforms, deployment and operational system design. We make extensive use of virtualised platforms and distributed processing using Hadoop.

Large scale PHP based Middleware systems, based on Zend Framework

CourtviewMedia

CTO

January 2008 - October 2009 (1 year 10 months)

London, England, United Kingdom

Working to bring up an innovative vertical social network aimed at youth sports, responsible for platforms, architecture and scalability. Also locating, hiring and managing a team of engineers to execute on the vision.

Fav.or.it

CTO

June 2008 - November 2008 (6 months)

Reading, England, United Kingdom

Responsible for technical management and development of the fav.or.it product, a unique Blog content aggregation system. Fav.or.it is a solaris hosted PHP application running under Zend Framework

Yahoo International

4 years 7 months

International Solutions Architect

October 2007 - February 2008 (5 months)

London, England, United Kingdom

- In addition to Prime Solution Architects Role.....
- Help to create strategies for building and hosting international yahoo properties.
- Support Engineering teams in International with migration to several new Yahoo internal standards.
- Evangelise the use of agile product development techniques to international engineering teams.
- Create Presentations on various topics at external events such as BarCamp, dConstruct and @media.
- Assist in the design of the next generation of Yahoo platforms by vetting and providing consultancy on i18n and l10n.

Solutions Architect , Audience and Content Management

June 2007 - October 2007 (5 months)

* Refocused role on Content management and content integrations/ aggregation

Prime Solutions Architect

April 2006 - June 2007 (1 year 3 months)

- New role family in Yahoo, I am responsible for starting up and creating the Solution Architecture group within the shared services group supporting Yahoo International Engineering.
- Assisting internal groups to navigate and prepare documents that conform to the International process.
- Vetting projects to ensure compliance with product standards agreed during 3 monthly negotiations with the global architecture group.
- Provide consultancy and Presentations support to internal workshops aimed at providing product teams with insights into potential integrations between yahoo platforms.
- Design of content middleware services for broad adoption globally.
- Support of Yahoo EU's Tech PR initiatives through creation of Yahoo "Hackday" events in conjunction with the BBC.
- Support the Patent generation process in EU.
- Assist EU teams in understanding global direction of Yahoo Products developed in other regions.

Engineering Manager - Regional Engineering (Europe)

September 2005 - April 2006 (8 months)

- Took on responsibility for all non-media related activities in EU engineering, Homepage, MyYahoo, Comms (messenger, mail), Search, Local search, Communities etc.
- Team expanded to 22 indirect, 5 direct.
- Responsible for all localisation of global products delivered in EU region.
- Responsible for identifying potential Products in yahoo international orgs, that could be re-factored to be delivered on a global scale.
- Responsible for assisting corp. dev in identifying potential 3rd party companies, that would make good candidates for acquisition. And assisting with due diligence.
- Responsible for all EU billing systems and security.
- Report directly to VP of engineering Europe.

Engineering Manager, Search, Local Search, Communities, Consumer and Network Services

December 2004 - September 2005 (10 months)

- Added responsibility for Communities and Communications products to existing role.
- Team expanded to 14.
- Responsible for identifying new team roles and hiring and training managers.
- Responsible for assisting in shaping new roles and functions in European engineering restructuring.
- Platform is Unix based, Apache, FreeBSD, PHP, MySQL, Oracle

Head of Search Engineering

August 2003 - December 2004 (1 year 5 months)

- Responsible for technical provisioning of search on Yahoo portal in 6 European countries.
- Responsible for i18n and l10n provision of Search Services.
- Managing team of 7 engineers, 2 in UK, 3 in Germany, 2 in Bangalore
- Responsible for evaluating new search products for European suitability.
- Responsible for operation of Search Farms hosted in Europe and US.
- Responsible for metrics and reporting on European Search.
- Responsible for Disaster recovery and Business Continuity Planning.
- Responsible for revenue reporting.
- Report to VP Engineering, and Search Business Unit MD.
- Platform is Unix based, Apache, FreeBSD, PHP, Custom Template Language

Associated Media Base

Systems Analyst/Architect

2001 - 2003 (2 years)

London, England, United Kingdom

Associated Media Base is the engineering arm of the Daily Mail Group and Trust (DMGT).

- Responsible for design of a migration strategy for Loot.com to a 3rd party delivery platform.
- Integration with Windows DNA 2000 based application and external 3rd party content management system (Media Surface).
- Evaluation of .NET architecture for suitable platform for Loot.com service.
- Assisted in migration of Loot Publishing systems to Media Planner/CCI

Scoot Ltd

Content Manager

1999 - 2002 (3 years)

Hillingdon, England, United Kingdom

- Responsible for planning and managing the merger of systems between LOOT.com and Scoot UK Ltd when company was acquired, re-architected web applications hosted by Scoot to conform to Loot Ltd standards, and supervised their re-implementation, re-launched service in June 2001. Designed complete geographically distributed hosting architecture and software system that minimised any risk of down-time. Extensive use of Replication on 9 x SQL server data repository.
- Responsible for designing content architectures and structures to allow syndication of Loot/Scoot content base to other companies, as well as being able to aggregate content from other suppliers.

Loot Ltd

Software Consultant

1991 - 1999 (8 years)

Kilburn, England, United Kingdom

- Designed and implemented LOOT.com, at the time, the UK's most trafficked classifieds site, which won many awards, including the Lotus Work the web award, and the Professional Publishing Association awards. Completed design and implementation of both the software running on the site, plus the complete hosting system, loot.com was hosted completely in-house, Responsible for set-up of DNS, Web farm, load balancing systems, database systems,

monitoring and alerting, SMTP mail systems and complete staging facilities.

Wrote the search engine used on the site.

Worked with Microsoft on building out a version of LOOT.com that was a launch partner for MS Windows 95, site was featured heavily on launch advertising.

- Loot.com takes about 30-35 million hits (pages) per month. And about 0.5 million unique users.
- Application circa 120,000 lines of C++, 80 Main Classes.
- Skills: Visual C++, SQL server 6.5 + 7.0. NT 4 and win2k (beta program), XML, ISAPI.
- Managed a team of 3 Development engineers and 2 Operations/Service engineers.

NTG 2000

Technical Director

1989 - 1991 (2 years)

Cheltenham, England, United Kingdom

- Design and implementation of Loot's internal pagination system Eagle. Eagle is a unique windows based application that uses an object orientated database system (OODBMS)
- Skills: Borland C++, POET OODBMS, Oracle, SQL server, NT (on first beta program).
- A PC based Postscript raster imaging system, optimised for large format colour page output and high quality magazine formats. (Zortech C++)
- A DOS based newspaper pagination system with advanced "live" connectivity to advertising feeds. Distributed design allowed additional workstations to be added to increase overall processing power of the advertising cluster.
- System was used extensively in Milan by Italian publishing group "Secondamano". Spent 1 year on site supervising installation and roll-out.
- A Postscript page imposition system used by the Office of Official Publications of the European Union to prepare plates for reports of proceedings in the European parliament. (Borland C++)

Pagitek Ltd

Software engineer

1983 - 1989 (6 years)

Tewkesbury, England, United Kingdom

- Responsible for providing sales group with technical backup and "prototypes" of custom software solutions and content management systems. Pagitek was

a leader in the production of book pagination systems and journalist entry system for newspapers.

- Responsible for evaluating customer requirements and generating proposals and designs to suit.
- Responsible for auditing/vetting proposals generated by the Marketing/Sales group to ensure accuracy and suitability for implementation.
- Designed and Implemented "Edition" a Macintosh based Quark xPress extension designed to automate layout of pages using page layout imported from external page planning package. (CodeWarrior)

Linotype

Senior Software Engineer

June 1980 - June 1985 (5 years 1 month)

Cheltenham, England, United Kingdom

Designed and built custom products and solutions for the graphics arts industry, based around proprietary mini-computer technology.

National Air Traffic Services

ATCE Grade II

1976 - 1981 (5 years)

West Drayton, England, United Kingdom

Maintained systems to monitor ground to air communications, and internal video distribution systems.

Maintained Voice and Data recording systems

Designed programs using a microconsultants computer system to log data from multiple aviation systems.

Obtained vocational qualifications at the CAA engineering school at Bletchly Park. Solid State Engineering, Radar Systems, Transmitters and Receivers.

Education

Bletchley Park College of Telecommunications Engineering

ONC/HNC, Electronic Engineering · (1974 - 1977)

Queen Victoria School, Dunblane, Scotland

· (1968 - 1974)